

Learning How to Learn: The Trial Run

学会学习：第一次试行

Theme: 学习方法与教育 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The trial run had a **new** shape: one afternoon, one **line** of questions, and a small group of volunteers. Each carried a **soft** pencil and a printed page. The **engineer** who designed the form was **curious** about a single number — how many people could find the answer without help. “Few,” she said, when the first results came in. “That is the problem.”

The **performance** was better than they had feared. A **humble** typist, an **ace** with a **needle** and a length of **silk ribbon**, fixed the broken sign in ten minutes, and a **ham** sandwich with **butter** bought her a grateful hour. A girl in a **cat** sweater asked whether the map worked for someone who could not read; nobody answered. “That is the **catch**,” Maya said. “We wrote for the wrong reader.” A **rumor** went round the library that the group had taken money from a bakery; the **toast** and **butter** tasted better than that story.

The **content** of the next version had to change. They would **compose** it in three languages, **diversify** the examples, and add a **line** for readers who preferred pictures. “It is **awkward**,” Lin admitted. “It is also **accessible**.” A historical exhibit on **Christianity** gave them an unexpected lesson: a manuscript copied by hand by a **Christian** scribe whose name was never recorded, with one old note about **Christ** in the margin. “That is the **pioneer** of our profession,” the librarian said. “**Efficiency** came later.” **Chalk** dust still lay on the shelf beneath it.

Recognition arrived in small forms. A professor praised their “**purity** of method” and then misspelled Maya’s name in the citation. A **fiber** of doubt remained. “I am not **hopeless** about it,” she said. “I am just not finished.” An **innocent** remark about a **clumsy** diagram started an hour-long argument, and her **finger** stayed on the page the whole time. A **responsive** reader, they learned, beats ten quiet ones.

A **mammal**, a **pizza** box, and a book of riddles shared one table by the end of the week. Their **flexible** schedule allowed one more trial; **other** volunteers signed up. Not every session was useful; most were not, and nobody could say quite why. “Write it down anyway,” she said. “Again.” Nobody knew how much the answer depended on luck. It was, in his words, a **trifle**: three hundred grams of paper and a million intentions. “Some things are **infectious**,” Maya said. “Curiosity is one of them. **Wake me** when the next batch arrives.” Many notes were his, and the study would carry all of them. She smiled at the **clumsy** sentence he had just written; the **wrinkle** beside her eye showed she had slept badly. “No,” she said.

中文翻译

试行的形态是新的：一个下午、一条问题线，以及一小群志愿者。每人手里一支软铅笔和一张打印页。设计表格的工程师只对一个数字感到好奇——有多少人能够在没有帮助的情况下找到答案。“很少，”第一轮结果出来时她说，“这就是问题。”

表现比他们担心的要好。一位谦逊的打字员用一根针和一段丝带，十分钟就修好了坏掉的指示牌，一个火腿三明治换来了她感激的一小时。一个穿猫毛衣的女孩问，这张地图对一个不识字的人是否管用；没有人能回答。“这就是陷阱，”曼雅说，“我们为错误的读者写作。”图书馆里传开一则谣言，说小组收了一家面包店的钱；早餐的吐司都比那个故事更可信。

下一版的内容必须改变。他们要用三种语言编写，使例子多样化，并为更喜欢图画的读者加一行。“这很笨拙，”林伟承认，“但它也更容易接近。”阅览室里一场关于基督教的史料展给了他们意外的教训：一份手抄手稿，一个字母一个字母地抄写，抄写者是一位没有留下姓名的基督徒，页边还有一句关于基督的旧注。“这就是我们这一行的先驱，”图书管理员说，“效率是后来的事。”它下面的书架上还落着粉笔灰。

认可以小形式到来。一位教授称赞他们“方法的纯净”，随后在引注里把曼雅的名字拼错了。一丝怀疑仍在。“我并不是对它绝望，”她说，“我只是还没做完。”一句关于一张笨拙图表的无心之言引发了长达一小时的争论，而她的手指一直停在那一页上。他们明白了：一个反应灵敏的读者，抵得上十个沉默的读者。

到那个周末，一只哺乳动物、一个比萨盒和一本谜语书共用同一张桌子。他们灵活的安排允许再做一次试行，又有其他志愿者报了名。并不是每一次都有用；大多数没有用，也没人说得清究竟为什么。“还是写下来吧，”她说，“一次再一次。”用他的话来说，这只是小事一桩：三百克纸和一百万个好意。“有些东西是会传染的，”曼雅说，“好奇心就是其中之一。下一批到的时候叫醒我。”很多笔记都是他写的，而这份研究会把它们全部保留下来。她对他刚写下的那句笨拙的话笑了笑，眼角那道细纹是她睡得不好的唯一迹象。“不，”她说。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
other 'ʌðə POS: a	a. 其他的, 另外的, 从前的; pron. 其他的, 他人, 另外一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not the same one or ones already mentioned or implied; s. recently past; s. very unusual; different in chara...
new nju: POS: a	a. 新的, 陌生的, 最近的, 不熟悉的; [法] 新发现的, 新的, 重新开始的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not of long duration; having just (or relatively recently) come into being or been made or acquired or dis...
line lain POS: n	n. 列, 线, 绳, 电线, 线路, 路线, 航线, 作业线, 界线, 战线, 外形, 排, 家系; vt. 排成一行, 顺...排列, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formation of people or things one beside another; n. a mark that is long relative to its width; n. a forma...
catch kætf POS: n	n. 捕捉, 陷阱, 捕捉之物, 抓, 拉手; vt. 捕捉, 赶上, 感染, 听清楚; vi. 抓住, 燃着 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a drawback or difficulty that is not readily evident; n. the quantity that was caught; n. a person regarded...
performance pə'fɔ:məns POS: n	n. 施行, 工作情况, 成绩, 行为, 表现, 演出; [电] 绩效, 性能 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dramatic or musical entertainment; n. the act of presenting a play or a piece of music or other entertain...
finger 'fingə POS: n	n. 手指, 指状物, (手套的)手指部分, 指针; v. 用手指拨弄, 伸出; [计] 网络命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of the terminal members of the hand (sometimes excepting the thumb); n. the length of breadth of a fing...
Christian 'kristʃən POS: n	n. 基督徒, 正派人; a. 基督的, 基督教的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a religious person who believes Jesus is the Christ and who is a member of a Christian denomination; a. rel...
content kən'tent POS: n	n. 内容, 满足, 意义, 要旨; a. 满足的, 满意的; vt. 使...满足, 使...安心; [计] 内容 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. everything that is included in a collection and that is held or included in something; n. the proportion of...
soft sɒft POS: a	a. 软的, 温和的, 柔和的, 柔滑的, 温柔的, 软弱的, 坡度小的, 笨的, 纸币的; n. 柔软的东西, 笨人, 纸币; adv. 柔... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. yielding readily to pressure or weight; a. compassionate and kind; conciliatory; a. (of sound) relatively lo...
recognition ,rekəg'nɪʃən POS: n	n. 赞誉, 认得, 识别, 承认, 认可, 认识; [电] 认识 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state or quality of being recognized or acknowledged; n. the process of recognizing something or someone...
cat kæt POS: n	n. 猫, 恶妇; vi. 呕吐; 计算机辅助教育, 计算机辅助测试, 计算机辅助翻译, 计算机辅助排版; [计] 计算机辅助教学, 计算机辅助... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. feline mammal usually having thick soft fur and no ability to roar: domestic cats; wildcats; n. a spiteful...
wake weɪk POS: vt	vt. 叫醒, 激发; vi. 醒来, 醒着, 觉醒, 活跃起来; n. 守候, 守夜, 尾迹, 痕迹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the wave that spreads behind a boat as it moves forward; n. a vigil held over a corpse the night before bur...
engineer ,endʒɪ'niə POS: n	n. 工程师, 工兵; vt. 设计, 监造, 精明地处理, 策划 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who uses scientific knowledge to solve practical problems; n. the operator of a railway locomotive...
Christ kraɪst POS: n	n. 基督, 救世主 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a teacher and prophet born in Bethlehem and active in Nazareth; his life and sermons form the basis for Chr...
efficiency ,ɪ'fɪjənsi POS: n	n. 效率, 效能, 功效; [医] 效率, 效力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the ratio of the output to the input of any system; n. skillfulness in avoiding wasted time and effort
butter 'bʌtə POS: n	n. 奶油, 黄油; vt. 涂黄油于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an edible emulsion of fat globules made by churning milk or cream; for cooking and table use; n. a fighter...
fiber 'faɪbə POS: n	n. 纤维, 构造, 纤维制品; [化] 纤维 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slender and greatly elongated substance capable of being spun into yarn; n. any of several elongated, thr...
innocent 'ɪnəsənt POS: a	a. 无辜的, 不懂事的, 无知的; n. 天真的人, 笨蛋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who lacks knowledge of evil; a. free from evil or guilt; s. lacking intent or capacity to injure; s....
curious 'kjʊəriəs POS: a	a. 好奇的, 求知的, 古怪的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. beyond or deviating from the usual or expected; a. eager to investigate and learn or learn more (sometimes...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
flexible 'fleksəbl POS: a	a. 易曲的, 灵活的, 柔顺的, 能变形的, 可通融的; [医] 能屈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being changed; a. able to flex; able to bend easily; s. bending and snapping back readily without...
compose kəm'pəuz POS: vt	vt. 组成, 写作, 作曲, 使平静; vi. 创作, 排字; [计] 编写 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. form the substance of; v. write music; v. put together out of existing material; v. calm (someone, especially)...
silk silk POS: n	n. 丝, 绸, 绸缎类, 丝织品; a. 丝的, 丝织的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fabric made from the fine threads produced by certain insect larvae; n. animal fibers produced by silkworm...
needle 'ni:dl POS: n	n. 针, 尖; vt. 用针缝; vi. 缝纫; [计] 探针 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slender pointer for indicating the reading on the scale of a measuring instrument; n. a sharp pointed imp...
rumor 'ru:mə POS: n	n. 谣言, 传闻; vt. 谣传 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. gossip (usually a mixture of truth and untruth) passed around by word of mouth; v. tell or spread rumors
Christianity 'kristʃi'æniti POS: n	n. 基督教, 基督教精神 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a monotheistic system of beliefs and practices based on the Old Testament and the teachings of Jesus as em...
pizza 'pi:tʃə POS: n	n. 比萨饼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Italian open pie made of thin bread dough spread with a spiced mixture of e.g. tomato sauce and cheese
awkward 'ɔ:kwəd POS: a	a. 笨拙的, 棘手的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. causing inconvenience; a. lacking grace or skill in manner or movement or performance; s. difficult to handle...
accessible ək'sesəbl POS: a	a. 易接近的, 可进入的, 可使用的, 易受影响的, 可理解的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of being reached; s. capable of being read with comprehension; s. easily obtained; s. easy to get along...
pioneer 'paɪə'niə POS: n	n. 先锋, 拓荒者, 创始人; vt. 提倡, 开辟, 开创, 倡导; vi. 作先驱, 开路; a. 最早的, 开拓的, 先驱的, 有开拓者... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who helps to open up a new line of research or technology or art; n. one of the first colonists or settlers...
ribbon 'ribən POS: n	n. 缎带, 色带, 带状物; vt. 用丝带装饰, 把...撕成条状; vi. 形成带状; [计] 带状条, 格式栏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any long object resembling a thin line; n. a long strip of inked material for making characters on paper with...
ace eis POS: n	n. 幺点, 好手, 少许, 发球得分; a. 一流的, 杰出的; [计] 应答允许, 自适应计算机试验, 自动呼叫设备, 自动执行控制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of four playing cards in a deck having a single pip on its face; n. someone who is dazzlingly skilled in...
mammal mæməl POS: n	n. 哺乳动物; [化] 哺乳动物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any warm-blooded vertebrate having the skin more or less covered with hair; young are born alive except for...
toast təʊst POS: n	n. 吐司, 烤面包, 干杯; vt. 敬酒, 烤, 使暖和; vi. 烤, 烘 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. slices of bread that have been toasted; n. a celebrity who receives much acclaim and attention; v. propose a...
humble 'hʌmbl POS: a	a. 低下的, 谦逊的, 粗陋的; vt. 使...卑下, 降低...地位, 贬抑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to be unpretentious; s. low or inferior in station or quality; a. marked by meekness or modesty; not a...
chalk tʃɔ:k POS: n	n. 粉笔, 白垩; vt. 用粉笔写, 记录 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a soft whitish calcite; n. a pure flat white with little reflectance; n. a piece of calcite or a similar substance...
ham hæm POS: n	n. 火腿, 后腿, 笨拙演员; a. 过火的, 做作的; v. 演得过火 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. meat cut from the thigh of a hog (usually smoked); n. (Old Testament) son of Noah; n. a licensed amateur radio operator...
hopeless 'heʊplɪs POS: a	a. 无希望的, 绝望的, 不可救药的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. without hope because there seems to be no possibility of comfort or success; s. of a person unable to do so...
responsive ri'spɒnsɪv POS: a	a. 回答的, 应答的, 易感应的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. containing or using responses; alternating; a. readily reacting or replying to people or events or stimuli;...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
infectious in'fekʃəs POS: a	a. 有传染性的, 易传染的; [医] 传染性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. caused by infection or capable of causing infection; a. easily spread; children catch it from their elders"...
purity 'pjʊəreɪ POS: n	n. 纯净, 纯正, 纯粹; [化] 纯度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. being undiluted or unmixed with extraneous material; n. the state of being unsullied by sin or moral wrong;...
wrinkle 'rɪŋkl POS: n	n. 皱纹, 妙计, 方法, 技巧; vi. 起皱; vt. 使起皱纹 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a slight depression in the smoothness of a surface; n. a minor difficulty; n. a clever method of doing somet...
diversify dai've:sɪfaɪ POS: vt	vt. 使多样化, 使变化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make (more) diverse; v. spread into new habitats and produce variety or variegate; v. vary in order to sprea...
clumsy 'klʌmzi POS: a	a. 笨拙的, 不雅观的, 粗陋的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lacking grace in movement or posture; s. not elegant or graceful in expression; s. difficult to handle or manag...
gram græm POS: n	n. 克, 绿豆, 鹰嘴豆; [医] 克 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a metric unit of weight equal to one thousandth of a kilogram; n. Danish physician and bacteriologist who d...
trifle 'traɪfl POS: n	n. 琐事, 少量; vt. 浪费; vi. 开玩笑, 翻弄, 虚度光阴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a cold pudding made of layers of sponge cake spread with fruit or jelly; may be decorated with nuts, cream...